

## Longitudinal Observation Regime



Regular cohorts;  
Repeated scheduled visits



Irregular EHR  
trajectories;  
Event-driven  
observations



Behavioral / language  
timelines;  
Sparse evolving  
histories



Asynchronous  
multimodal data;  
Modalities observed  
at different times

## Temporal Evidence

Repeated  
observations

Ordering /  
chronology

Unequal time  
gaps

Missing or  
sparse visits

Long-range  
history

State changes /  
transitions

*Temporal evidence  
arises from  
dependencies between  
observations over time.*

## Temporal Objective

*What must be inferred  
from change over time?*

Trajectory  
classification

Transition  
detection

Forecasting

Temporal  
summarization

Representation  
learning

Multimodal  
progression

## Modeling Inductive Bias

Sequential  
dependence

Time-gap  
awareness

History  
selection

Long-range  
context

State-transition  
sensitivity

Cross-modal  
alignment

*Model capacity alone  
does not establish  
longitudinal reasoning.*

## Claim-Conditioned Evaluation

Cross-subject claim → Subject-disjoint split

Sequential / progression claim → Temporal or horizon-aware evaluation

Missingness / multimodal claim → Robustness stress tests

Uncertainty claim → Calibration

Domain-shift claim → External validation

Deployment claim → Prospective validation

***Evaluation should match the claim; not every dimension applies to every study.***